

Lit./Mythology





About the Course

Student get a glimpse of the world beyond English with a poetic biography and then focus on stories and myths created and collected in the 19th century, including Russian fairy tales, short stories from a variety of authors, and Dickens' famous text, A Christmas Carol.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grades 7-8



Placement & Combining Tips

Several readings are shared with Grades 5-6, though lesson plans include more advanced work for older students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist A Christmas Carol The Man Who Invented Christmas directed Short stories and other writings

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 7-8				
General Lit: Grades 7-8				Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



A Christmas Carol



The Man Who Invented Christmas directed

Short stories and other writings



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF](#)

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or

challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.

- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell you about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ INTRO

Today we will begin a novel in verse about the Cuban-Spanish Romantic poet Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda (1814-1873), who used her writing to speak out against injustice of all kinds. If you have not read her biography already, it is linked below.

∞ Article Link: Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

1. p.169-174 "Historical Note"
2. p.ix "Historical Background"
3. p.3-10 "Books are door-shaped" - "like oxen or mules."

- Who are the people? Make a character list. Each week, as you read, think about the different perspectives of the poems and how each one sees the same situation very differently. Share your observations in your narrations.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other? Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: What Are Free Verse Poems

WEEK 2 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What were your first impressions of these poems?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has his death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Why does Tula feel she is not so different from the slave girls she views from the barred window?
- Continue to add to your character list.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: José María Heredia biography

• COMPOSITION

What role do books and reading have in the story so far? How are the "rules" different for Tula? Caridad? The nuns?

WEEK 3 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

How would you describe this book (so far) to someone who had never read it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.25-35

- How do the decisions Tula's mother made differ from what she expects from Tula? What is your impression of her mother so far?
- Why does Tula feel she can free herself "only with words"?
- Why is Tula not allowed to read books? What are her mother and stepfather afraid of happening if she reads books?